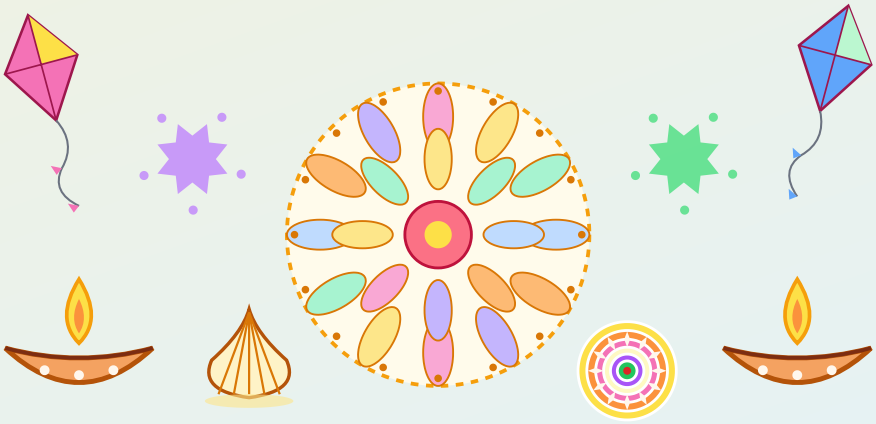
उत्सवाः

My Sanskrit Festival Workbook

संस्कृत-उत्सव-अभ्यास-पुस्तिका

Dīpāvalī · Gaṇeśa Caturthī · Navarātri · Vijayadaśamī · Oṇam · Makara Saṅkrānti · Mahāśivarātri · Holi · Rāma Navamī · Rakṣābandhana · Janmāṣṭamī · Festive adornment

Name / नाम: _____



For EdNet Learn members · ednetlearn.in

How to use · कथं प्रयोक्तव्यम्

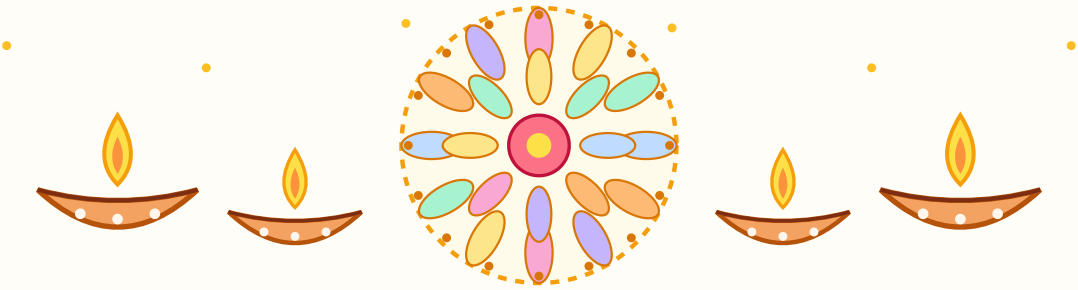
1. Each festival has two pages: words, then a śloka and small exercises.
2. Read each word aloud: first the Devanagari, then the sound (transliteration).
3. Learn the śloka slowly, one line a day, and read its meaning.
4. Do the exercises, then try the mixed quiz and check the answer key.
5. Use the greetings page to wish your family and friends in Sanskrit!

> Tip: words ending in -ḥ (ः) or -m (म्) are the usual naming forms. Some festival names here are given in Roman letters in Malayalam too, so you can recognise them.

Contents

1. Dīpāvalī · दीपावली
2. Gaṇeśa Caturthī · गणेशचतुर्थी
3. Navarātri · नवरात्रिः
4. Dasarā · Vijayadaśamī · विजयदशमी
5. Oṇam · ओणम्
6. Makara Saṅkrānti · मकरसङ्क्रान्तिः
7. Holi · होली
8. Mahāśivarātri · महाशिवरात्रिः
9. Rakṣābandhana · रक्षाबन्धनम्
10. Rāma Navamī · रामनवमी
11. Kṛṣṇa Janmāṣṭamī · कृष्णजन्माष्टमी
12. Festive adornment · शृङ्गारः · अलङ्कारः
13. The six seasons · षड् ऋतवः
14. The twelve months · मासाः
15. Mixed quiz · Greetings · Answer key

Dīpāvalī · दीपावली



Dīpāvalī means “a row of lamps”. Families clean their homes, draw raṅgavallī at the door, light lamps on the new-moon night of Kārtika, worship Lakṣmī and share sweets. It celebrates light over darkness.

Festival words · शब्दाः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
दीपः	dīpaḥ	lamp
दीपावली	dīpāvalī	row of lamps
प्रकाशः	prakāśaḥ	light
तैलम्	tailam	oil
वर्तिका	vartikā	wick
लक्ष्मीपूजा	lakṣmīpūjā	worship of Lakṣmī
रङ्गवल्ली	raṅgavallī	rangoli (coloured floor design)
मिष्टान्नम्	miṣṭānnam	sweets
नूतनवस्त्रम्	nūtanavastram	new clothes
अमावास्या	amāvāsyā	new-moon night

Dīpāvalī: śloka & practice

शुभं करोति कल्याणम् आरोग्यं धनसम्पदः ।
शत्रुबुद्धिविनाशाय दीपज्योतिर्नमोऽस्तु ते ॥



śubhaṃ karoti kalyāṇam ārogyaṃ dhanasampadaḥ |
śatrubuddhivināśāya dīpajyotir namo’stu te ||

Meaning: Salutations to you, light of the lamp, who bring goodness, well-being, health and wealth, and who remove hostile thoughts.

तमसो मा ज्योतिर्गमय । (tamaso mā jyotir gamaya: Lead me from darkness to light.)

1. Write the meaning

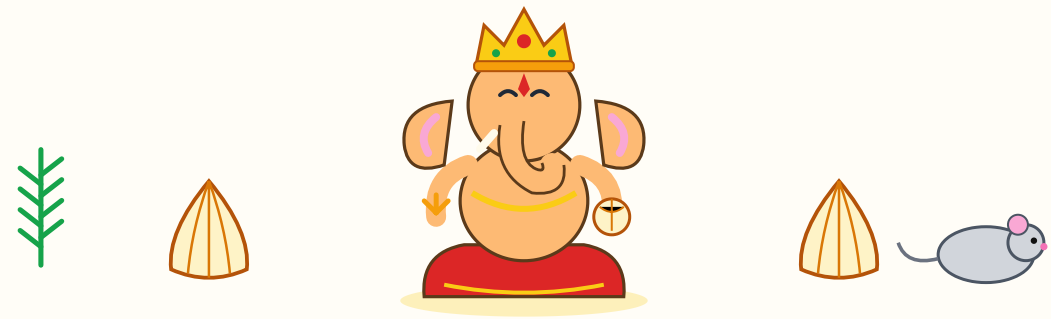
1. दीपः _____
2. तैलम् _____
3. रङ्गवल्ली _____

2. Write in Sanskrit

4. row of lamps _____
5. new-moon night _____

3. Copy the first line

Gaṇeśa Caturthī · गणेशचतुर्थी



On the fourth day (caturthī) of the bright half of Bhādrapada, families welcome Gaṇeśa home, offer modakas and dūrvā grass, sing together and, at the end, carry the image for visarjana (immersion).

Festival words · शब्दाः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
गणेशः	gaṇeśaḥ	Gaṇeśa
गणपतिः	gaṇapatiḥ	lord of the gaṇas
चतुर्थी	caturthī	the fourth day
मोदकः	modakaḥ	modaka (sweet dumpling)
मूषकः	mūṣakaḥ	mouse (Gaṇeśa's vehicle)
एकदन्तः	ekadantaḥ	the one-tusked one
लम्बोदरः	lambodaraḥ	the big-bellied one
विघ्नहर्ता	vighnahartā	remover of obstacles
दूर्वा	dūrvā	dūrvā grass
विसर्जनम्	visarjanam	immersion

Gaṇeśa Caturthī: śloka & practice

वक्रतुण्ड महाकाय सूर्यकोटिसमप्रभ ।
निर्विघ्नं कुरु मे देव सर्वकार्येषु सर्वदा ॥



vakratuṇḍa mahākāya sūryakoṭisamaprabha |
nirvighnaṃ kuru me deva sarvakāryeṣu sarvadā ||

Meaning: O Lord with the curved trunk and mighty body, shining like a crore suns, please make all my work free of obstacles, always.

1. Write the meaning

1. गणेशः _____
2. मोदकः _____
3. लम्बोदरः _____

2. Write in Sanskrit

4. lord of the gaṇas _____
5. immersion _____

3. Copy the first line

Navarātri · नवरात्रिः



For nine nights (Navarātri) the Devī is worshipped as Durgā, Lakṣmī and Sarasvatī. A kalaśa is set up on the first day, many people keep a fast, young girls are honoured (kanyā-pūjā), and in many places people dance garbā. On the last days books and tools are honoured.

Festival words · शब्दाः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
नवरात्रिः	navarātriḥ	nine nights
दुर्गा	durgā	Durgā
लक्ष्मीः	lakṣmīḥ	Lakṣmī
सरस्वती	sarasvatī	Sarasvatī
घटस्थापना	ghaṭasthāpanā	setting up the sacred pot (kalaśa)
कलशः	kalaśaḥ	sacred pot
उपवासः	upavāsaḥ	fasting
कन्यापूजा	kanyāpūjā	honouring young girls
महिषासुरमर्दिनी	mahiṣāsuramardinī	she who defeated Mahiṣāsura
गरबा	garbā	circle dance, from Sanskrit गर्भ (garbha), womb

Navarātri: śloka & practice

या देवी सर्वभूतेषु शक्तिरूपेण संस्थिता ।
नमस्तस्यै नमस्तस्यै नमस्तस्यै नमो नमः ॥





yā devī sarvabhūteṣu śaktirūpeṇa saṃsthitā |
namas tasyai namas tasyai namas tasyai namo namaḥ ||

Meaning: To the Goddess who lives in all beings as strength (śakti): salutations to her, again and again.

1. Write the meaning

1. नवरात्रिः _____
2. सरस्वती _____
3. उपवासः _____

2. Write in Sanskrit

4. Durgā _____
5. circle dance, from Sanskrit गर्भ (garbha), womb _____

3. Copy the first line

Dasarā · Vijayadaśamī · विजयदशमी



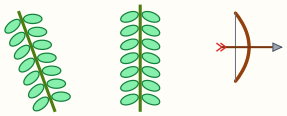
The tenth day after Navarātri is Vijayadaśamī, the day of victory. It remembers Rāma's victory over Rāvaṇa and the Devī's victory over Mahiṣāsura. In the north, effigies of Rāvaṇa are burnt after the Rāmlīlā; elsewhere tools and books are honoured (āyudha-pūjā), people exchange śamī leaves, cross the village border (sīmollaṅghana) and children start learning (vidyārambha).

Festival words · शब्दाः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
विजयदशमी	vijayadaśamī	the tenth day of victory
दशहरा	daśaharā	Dasarā (popular name, from Hindi)
विजयः	vijayaḥ	victory
रावणः	rāvaṇaḥ	Rāvaṇa
रावणदहनम्	rāvaṇadahanam	burning of Rāvaṇa's effigy
शमीवृक्षः	śamīvṛkṣaḥ	śamī tree
आयुधपूजा	āyudhapūjā	worship of tools and weapons
सीमोल्लङ्घनम्	sīmollaṅghanam	crossing the border
अपराजिता	aparājitā	the unconquered Devī
विद्यारम्भः	vidyārambhaḥ	beginning of learning

Dasarā · Vijayadaśamī: śloka & practice

शमी शमयते पापं शमी शत्रुविनाशिनी ।
अर्जुनस्य धनुर्धारी रामस्य प्रियदर्शिनी ॥



śamī śamayate pāpaṃ śamī śatruvināśinī |
arjunasya dhanurdhārī rāmasya priyadarśinī ||

Meaning: The śamī tree calms wrong-doing and removes enemies; it held Arjuna's bow and was dear to Rāma's eyes. (Recited at śamī-pūjā on Vijayadaśamī.)

1. Write the meaning

1. विजयदशमी _____
2. रावणः _____
3. आयुधपूजा _____

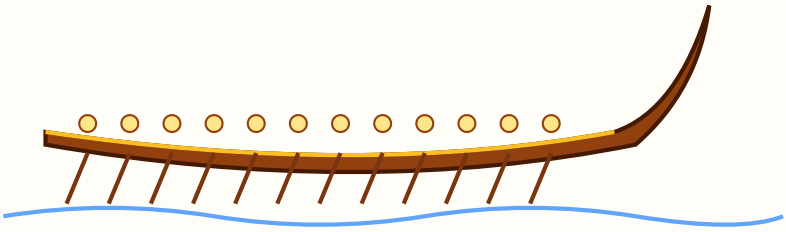
2. Write in Sanskrit

4. Dasarā (popular name, from Hindi) _____
5. beginning of learning _____

3. Copy the first line

Oṇam · ओणम्





Oṇam is Kerala's harvest festival in the month of Chingam, remembering the good king Mahābali and Vāmana. Homes make flower carpets (pookkalam), families share a big feast on banana leaves (sadya), and there are boat races (vallam kali) and swings (oonjal). The main day, Thiruvonam, falls on the Śravaṇa star.

Festival words · शब्दाः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
श्रवणम्	śravaṇam	Śravaṇa star (Thiruvonam day)
महाबलिः	mahābaliḥ	King Mahābali
वामनः	vāmanaḥ	Vāmana
पुष्परङ्गवल्ली	puṣparaṅgavallī	flower carpet (Malayalam: pookkalam)
भोजनम्	bhojanam	feast, meal (Malayalam: sadya)
कदलीपत्रम्	kadalīpatram	banana leaf
नौकास्पर्धा	naukāspardhā	boat race (Malayalam: vallam kali)
दोला	dolā	swing (Malayalam: oonjal)
उत्सवः	utsavaḥ	festival
केरलम्	keralam	Kerala

Oṇam: śloka & practice

सर्वे भवन्तु सुखिनः सर्वे सन्तु निरामयाः ।
सर्वे भद्राणि पश्यन्तु मा कश्चिद् दुःखभाग्भवेत् ॥



sarve bhavantu sukhinaḥ sarve santu nirāmayāḥ |
sarve bhadrāṇi paśyantu mā kaścid duḥkhabhāg bhavet ||

Meaning: May all be happy, may all be free from illness, may all see good things, may no one suffer. (Oṇam remembers a time when everyone was equal and happy.)

1. Write the meaning

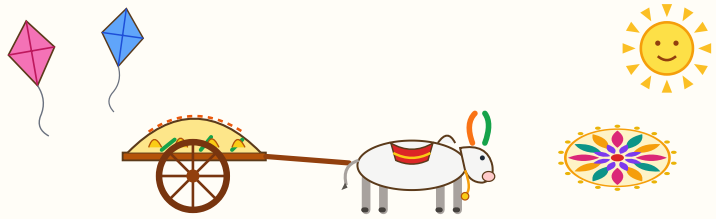
1. श्रवणम् _____
2. पुष्परङ्गवल्ली _____
3. नौकास्पर्धा _____

2. Write in Sanskrit

4. King Mahābali _____
5. Kerala _____

3. Copy the first line

Makara Saṅkrānti · मकरसङ्क्रान्तिः



When the sun enters Makara (Capricorn) in mid-January, its northward course (uttarāyaṇa) is celebrated. People take a holy bath, give gifts, fly kites and share sesame and jaggery sweets. It is a harvest festival with many regional names.

Festival words · शब्दाः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
मकरसङ्क्रान्तिः	makarasaṅkrāntiḥ	sun entering Makara
सूर्यः	sūryaḥ	sun
उत्तरायणम्	uttarāyaṇam	the sun's northward course
तिलः	tilaḥ	sesame
गुडः	guḍaḥ	jaggery
तिलगुडम्	tilaguḍam	sesame-jaggery sweet
पतङ्गः	pataṅgaḥ	kite
दानम्	dānam	giving, gift
स्नानम्	snānam	bath
धान्यम्	dhānyam	grain, harvest

One festival, many names

Makara Saṅkrānti, the sun entering Makara, is celebrated across India as:

Lohri
Punjab, the night before
bonfire; til, rewari and peanuts offered

Pongal
Tamil Nadu
new rice and milk boiled until they overflow

Uttarāyaṇ
Gujarat
kite flying from every rooftop

Bhogali / Māgh Bihu
Assam
harvest feast; meji bonfire at dawn

Poush Saṅkrānti
Bengal
piṭhā rice cakes with date-palm jaggery

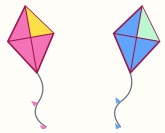
Maghi
Punjab / Himachal
holy dip and fairs; Maghi mela at Muktsar

Khichdi
Uttar Pradesh / Bihar
khichdi made and given; Gaṅgā snāna

Pedda Paṇḍaga / Ellu-bella
Andhra / Telangana / Karnataka
bommala koluvu dolls; gobbemmalu in muggulu

Makara Saṅkrānti: śloka & practice

ॐ मित्राय नमः । ॐ रवये नमः । ॐ सूर्याय नमः ।



oṃ mitrāya namaḥ | oṃ ravaye namaḥ | oṃ sūryāya namaḥ |

Meaning: Salutations to the friend of all, to the shining one, to the sun. (The first three Sūrya-namaskāra names.)

तिलगुडं गृहाण, मधुरं वद । (tilaguḍaṃ gṛhāṇa, madhuraṃ vada: Take sesame-jaggery, speak sweetly.)

1. Write the meaning

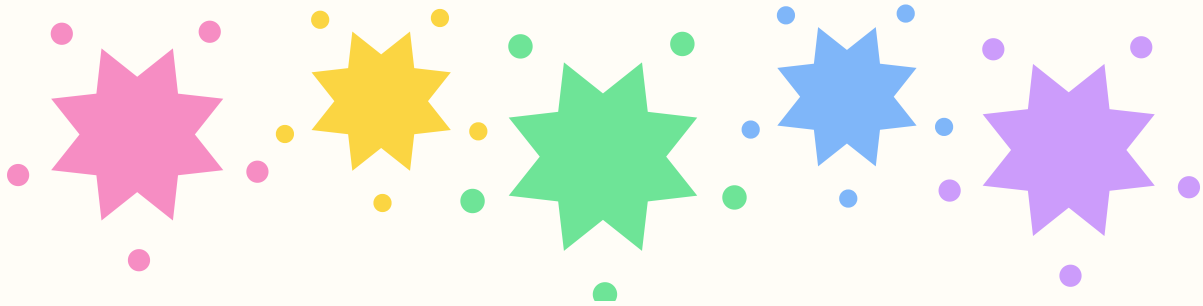
1. मकरसङ्क्रान्तिः _____
2. तिलः _____
3. पतङ्गः _____

2. Write in Sanskrit

4. sun _____
5. grain, harvest _____

3. Copy the first line

Holi · होली



Holi welcomes spring on the full moon of Phālguna. On the night before, the Holikā fire recalls how young Prahlāda was protected. Next day everyone plays with colours and shares sweets.

Festival words · शब्दाः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
होलिका	holikā	Holikā (the bonfire night)
प्रह्लादः	prahlādaḥ	Prahlāda
वसन्तः	vasantaḥ	spring
फाल्गुनः	phālgunaḥ	month of Phālguna
पूर्णिमा	pūrṇimā	full-moon day
रङ्गः	raṅgaḥ	colour
जलम्	jalam	water
हर्षः	harṣaḥ	joy
मित्रम्	mitram	friend

Holi: śloka & practice

असतो मा सद्गमय । तमसो मा ज्योतिर्गमय ।
मृत्योर्मा अमृतं गमय ॥



asato mā sad gamaya | tamaso mā jyotir gamaya |
mṛtyor mā amṛtaṃ gamaya ||

Meaning: Lead me from the unreal to the real, from darkness to light, from death to immortality. (Bṛhadāraṇyaka Upaniṣad 1.3.28)

1. Write the meaning

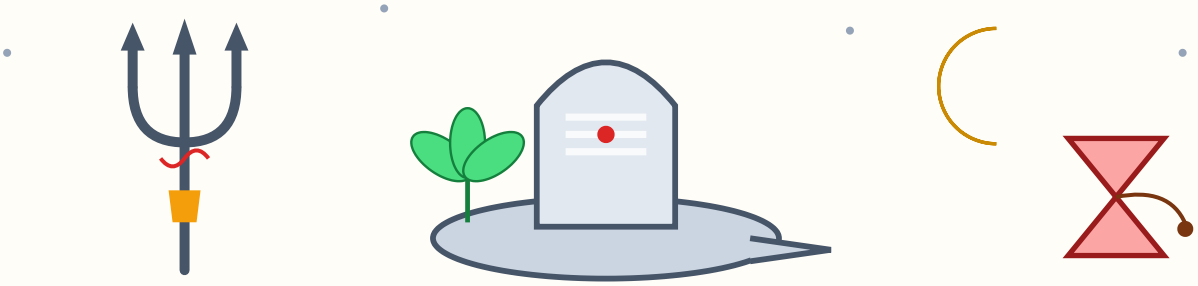
1. होलिका _____
2. फाल्गुनः _____
3. जलम् _____

2. Write in Sanskrit

4. Prahlāda _____
5. friend _____

3. Copy the first line

Mahāśivarātri · महाशिवरात्रिः



Mahāśivarātri, the great night of Śiva, falls on the fourteenth night of the dark fortnight of Māgha or Phālguna (February–March). Devotees fast, stay awake through the night (jāgaraṇa), offer water, milk and bilva leaves on the liṅga, and chant ॐ नमः शिवाय.

Festival words · शब्दाः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
शिवः	śivaḥ	Śiva
रात्रिः	rātriḥ	night
लिङ्गम्	liṅgam	the liṅga (Śiva's symbol)
बिल्वपत्रम्	bilvapatram	bilva leaf
त्रिशूलम्	triśūlam	trident
अर्धचन्द्रः	ardhacandraḥ	crescent moon
डमरुः	ḍamaruḥ	small hand drum
नन्दी	nandī	Nandī the bull
अभिषेकः	abhiṣekaḥ	pouring water or milk in worship
जागरणम्	jāgaraṇam	staying awake

Mahāśivarātri: śloka & practice

कर्पूरगौरं करुणावतारं संसारसारं भुजगेन्द्रहारम् ।
सदा वसन्तं हृदयारविन्दे भवं भवानीसहितं नमामि ॥



karpūragauraṃ karuṇāvatāraṃ saṃsārasāraṃ bhujagendrahāram |
sadā vasantaṃ hṛdayāravinde bhavaṃ bhavānīsahitaṃ namāmi ||

Meaning: I bow to Bhava (Śiva) together with Bhavānī: white as camphor, compassion in form, the essence of the world, wearing the king of serpents as a garland, always living in the lotus of the heart.

ॐ नमः शिवाय । (oṃ namaḥ śivāya: Salutations to Śiva.)

1. Write the meaning

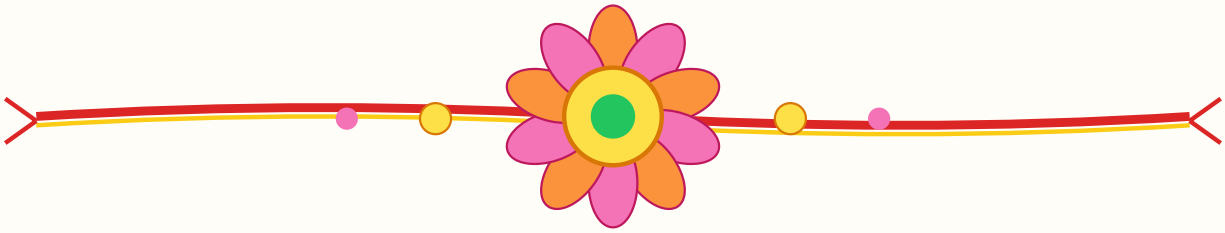
1. शिवः _____
2. बिल्वपत्रम् _____
3. डमरुः _____

2. Write in Sanskrit

4. night _____
5. staying awake _____

3. Copy the first line

Rakṣābandhana · रक्षाबन्धनम्



On the full moon of Śrāvaṇa, a sister ties a rakṣā (protective thread) on her brother’s wrist and puts a tilaka; the brother promises to protect her, and they share sweets and gifts.

Festival words · शब्दाः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
रक्षाबन्धनम्	rakṣābandhanam	tying of the protective thread
रक्षा	rakṣā	protection
सूत्रम्	sūtram	thread
भ्राता	bhrātā	brother
भगिनी	bhaginī	sister
तिलकम्	tilakam	mark on the forehead
श्रावणः	śrāvaṇaḥ	month of Śrāvaṇa
उपहारः	upahāraḥ	gift

Rakṣābandhana: śloka & practice

येन बद्धो बली राजा दानवेन्द्रो महाबलः ।
तेन त्वां प्रतिबध्नामि रक्षे मा चल मा चल ॥

yena baddho balī rājā dānavendro mahābalaḥ |
tena tvāṃ pratibadhnāmi rakṣe mā cala mā cala ||

Meaning: With the thread that bound the mighty King Bali, I tie you. O rakṣā, stay firm, do not slip away.

1. Write the meaning

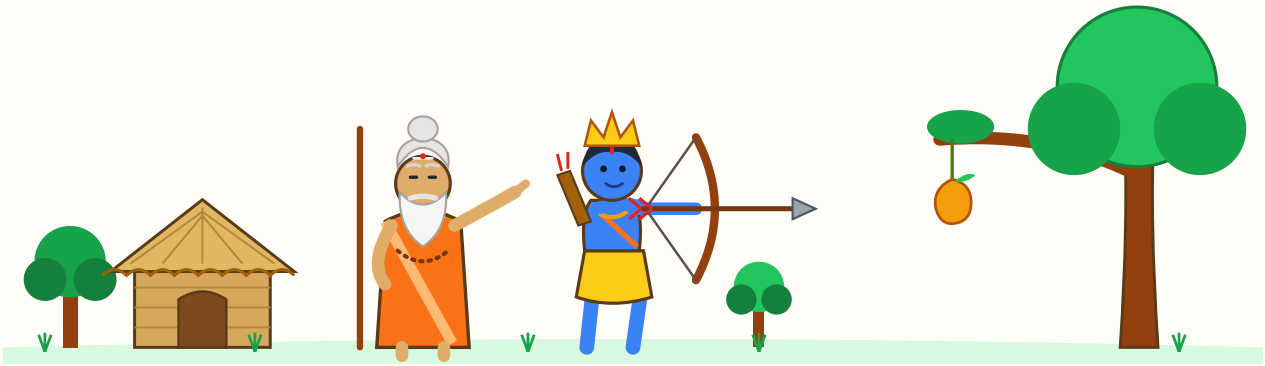
1. रक्षाबन्धनम् _____
2. भ्राता _____
3. श्रावणः _____

2. Write in Sanskrit

4. protection _____
5. gift _____

3. Copy the first line

Rāma Navamī · रामनवमी



Rāma Navamī celebrates the birth of Śrī Rāma on the ninth day (navamī) of the bright fortnight of Caitra, at noon. People read the Rāmāyaṇa, sing bhajans, decorate cradles and share pānaka (a jaggery drink) and buttermilk.

Festival words · शब्दाः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
रामः	rāmaḥ	Rāma
नवमी	navamī	the ninth day
अयोध्या	ayodhyā	Ayodhyā
दशरथः	daśarathaḥ	King Daśaratha
कौसल्या	kausalyā	Queen Kausalyā
सीता	sītā	Sītā
लक्ष्मणः	lakṣmaṇaḥ	Lakṣmaṇa
हनुमान्	hanumān	Hanumān
धनुः	dhanuḥ	bow
रामायणम्	rāmāyaṇam	the Rāmāyaṇa

Rāma Navamī: śloka & practice

श्रीराम राम रामेति रमे रामे मनोरमे ।
सहस्रनाम तत्तुल्यं रामनाम वरानने ॥





śrīrāma rāma rāmeti rame rāme manorame |
sahasranāma tattulyaṃ rāmanāma varānane ||

Meaning: (Śiva to Pārvatī) Chanting “Śrī Rāma, Rāma, Rāma”, I delight in the delightful Rāma. O lovely one, the name of Rāma is equal to the thousand names.

1. Write the meaning

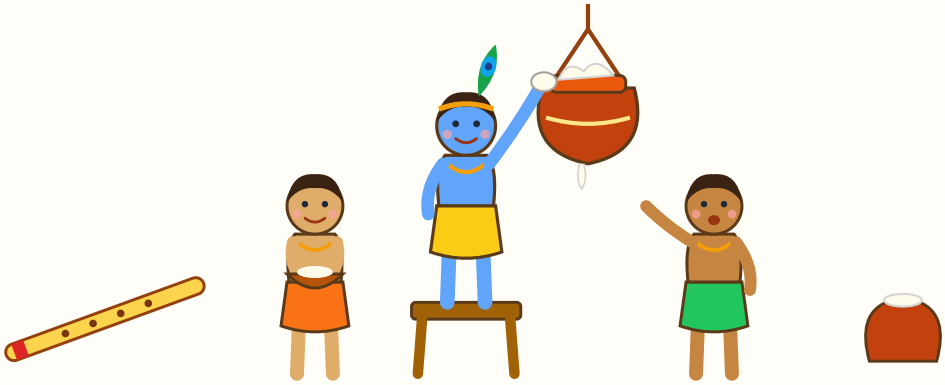
1. रामः _____
2. दशरथः _____
3. लक्ष्मणः _____

2. Write in Sanskrit

4. the ninth day _____
5. the Rāmāyaṇa _____

3. Copy the first line

Kṛṣṇa Janmāṣṭamī · कृष्णजन्माष्टमी



Janmāṣṭamī celebrates the birth of Kṛṣṇa at midnight on the eighth day (aṣṭamī) of the dark fortnight, in Śrāvaṇa or Bhādrapada depending on the calendar. Homes and temples sing bhajans, babies' cradles are decorated, and in Maharashtra young people form human towers to break the curd pot (dahi-handi).

Festival words · शब्दाः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
कृष्णः	kṛṣṇaḥ	Kṛṣṇa
जन्माष्टमी	janmāṣṭamī	birth on the eighth day
वेणुः	veṇuḥ	flute
मुरली	muralī	flute
मयूरपिच्छम्	mayūrapiccham	peacock feather
दधि	dadhi	curd
नवनीतम्	navanītam	fresh butter
दधिभाण्डम्	dadhibhāṇḍam	curd pot (popular name: dahi-handi, from Marathi/Hindi)
गोपालः	gopālaḥ	cowherd
मध्यरात्रिः	madhyarātriḥ	midnight

Kṛṣṇa Janmāṣṭamī: śloka & practice

वसुदेवसुतं देवं कंसचाणूरमर्दनम् ।
देवकीपरमानन्दं कृष्णं वन्दे जगद्गुरुम् ॥





vasudevasutaṃ devaṃ kaṃsacāṇūramardanam |
devakīparamānandaṃ kṛṣṇaṃ vande jagadgurum ||

Meaning: I bow to Kṛṣṇa, the teacher of the world: son of Vasudeva, who overcame Kaṃsa and Cāṇūra, the greatest joy of Devakī.

1. Write the meaning

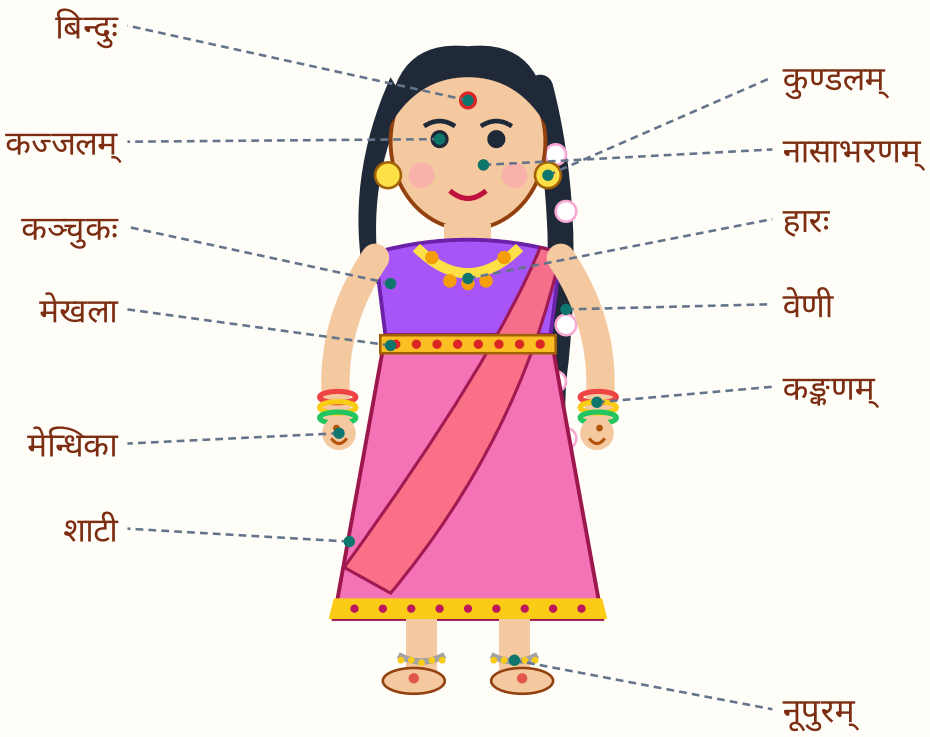
1. कृष्णः _____
2. मुरली _____
3. नवनीतम् _____

2. Write in Sanskrit

4. birth on the eighth day _____
5. midnight _____

3. Copy the first line

Festive adornment · शृङ्गारः · अलङ्कारः



On festival days girls and women dress in their best: a bright शाटी, flowers in the वेणी, a बिन्दुः on the forehead and jingling नूपुराणि. Each ornament has a lovely Sanskrit name.

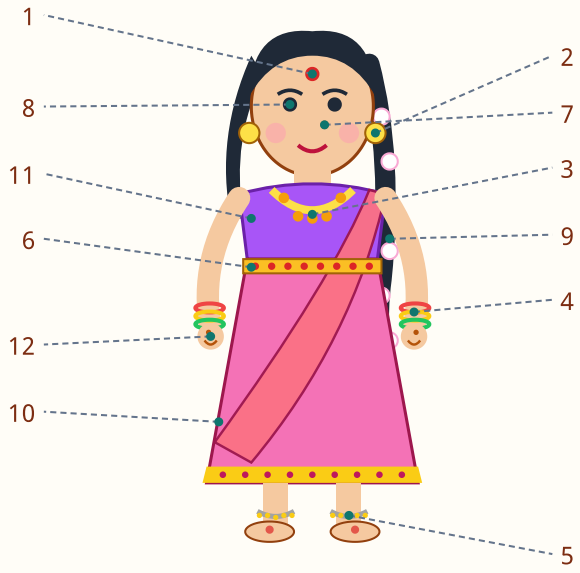
Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
शाटी	śāṭī	sari (also शाटिका)
कञ्चुकः	kañcukaḥ	bodice, blouse
चोली	colī	blouse (Hindi word; Sanskrit चोलः / कञ्चुकः)
बिन्दुः	binduḥ	dot on the forehead (bindi)
तिलकम्	tilakam	mark on the forehead
कज्जलम्	kajjalam	kohl, kājal
कुण्डलम्	kuṇḍalam	earring
नासाभरणम्	nāsābharaṇam	nose ornament
हारः	hāraḥ	necklace

Adornment words · अलङ्काराः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
कङ्कणम्	kaṅkaṇam	bracelet, bangle
वलयम्	valayam	bangle
अङ्गुलीयकम्	aṅgulīyakam	finger ring
मेखला	mekhalā	waist belt, girdle
नूपुरम्	nūpuram	anklet
मेन्धिका	mendhikā	henna, mehendī (mehendī is the Hindi word)
वेणी	veṇī	braid
पुष्पमाला	puṣpamālā	flower garland
माला · स्रक्	mālā · srak	garland
जपमाला	japamālā	prayer beads
रङ्गवल्ली	raṅgavallī	rangoli
तोरणम्	toraṇam	door garland, festive arch

Words marked “Hindi word” are modern names; the Sanskrit word is given beside them.

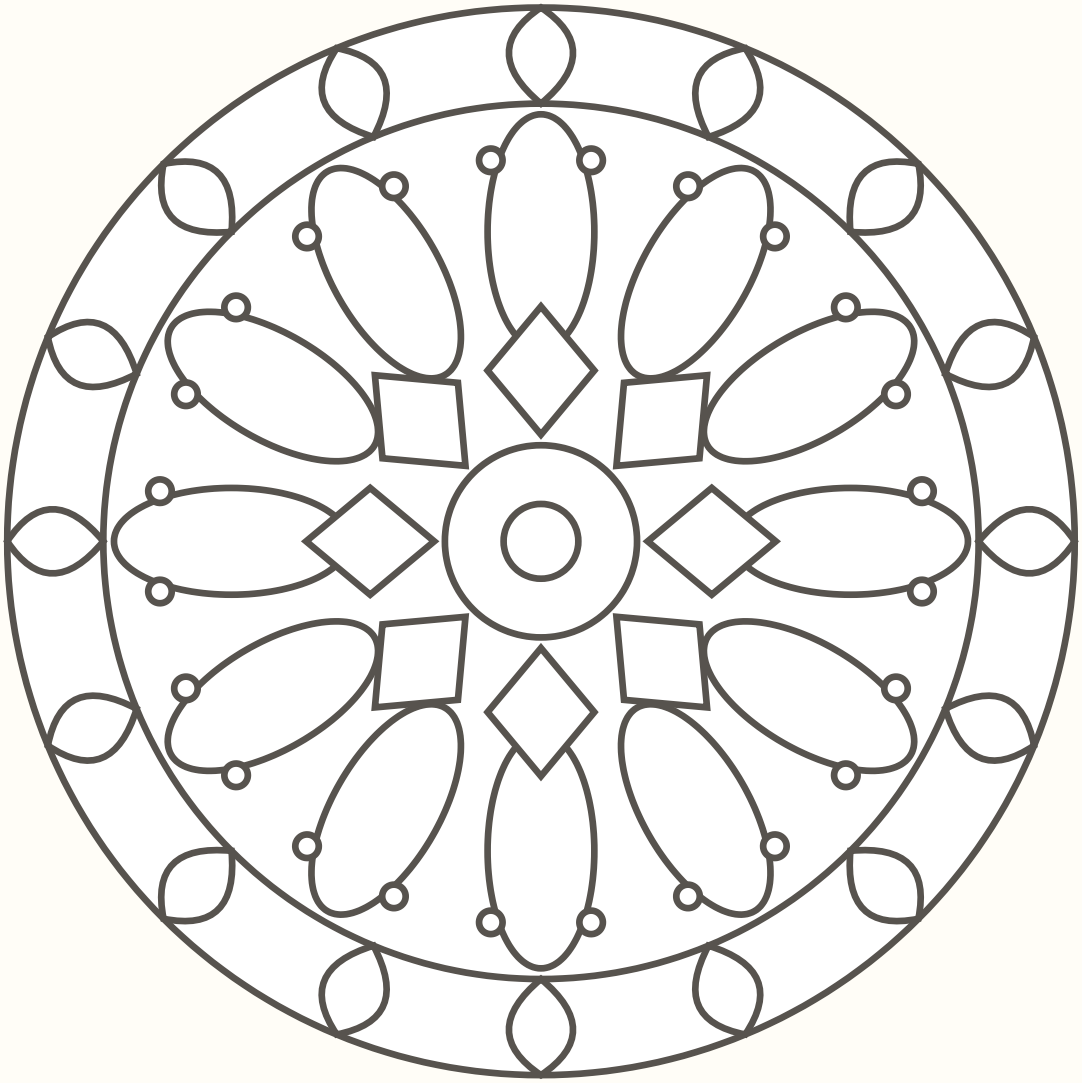
Label the picture · चित्रे नामानि लिखत



1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____

Colour the rangoli · रङ्गवल्लीं रञ्जयत

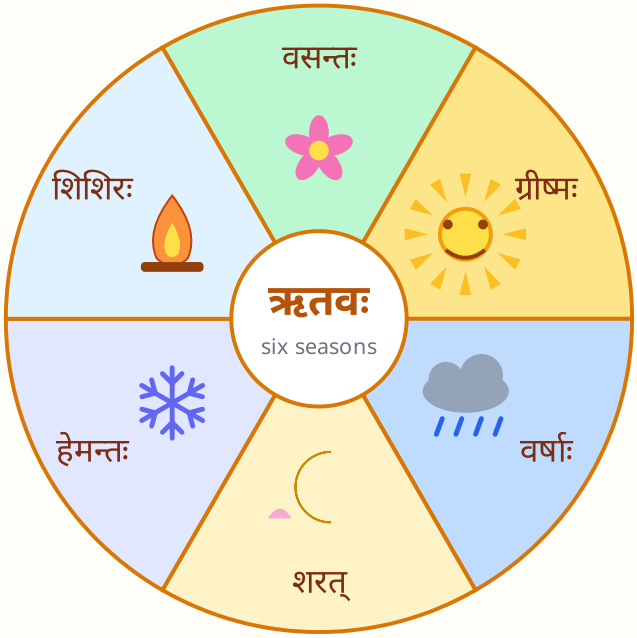
Colour the rangoli and the toraṇa with your favourite colours. Write a colour word (रक्तः, पीतः, हरितः, नीलः …) beside each ring.



Write the Sanskrit word

1. door garland _____ · 2. flower garland _____ · 3. anklet _____

The six seasons · षड् ऋतवः



The Indian year has six seasons (ṛtu, ऋतु), each two lunar months long. The Gregorian months are approximate, because lunar months shift a little every year.

Season	Sound · meaning	Lunar months	About
वसन्तः	vasantaḥ spring	चैत्रः, वैशाखः Caitra, Vaiśākha	mid-March – mid-May
ग्रीष्मः	grīṣmaḥ summer	ज्येष्ठः, आषाढः Jyeṣṭha, Āṣāḍha	mid-May – mid-July
वर्षाः	varṣāḥ rainy season	श्रावणः, भाद्रपदः Śrāvaṇa, Bhādrapada	mid-July – mid-September
शरत्	śarat autumn	आश्विनः, कार्तिकः Āśvina, Kārtika	mid-September – mid-November
हेमन्तः	hemantaḥ early winter	मार्गशीर्षः, पौषः Mārgaśīrṣa, Pauṣa	mid-November – mid-January
शिशिरः	śiśiraḥ late winter	माघः, फाल्गुनः Māgha, Phālguna	mid-January – mid-March

Seasons: festivals & nature words

Season	Festivals	Nature words
वसन्तः	Ugādi / Gudi Padwa, Rāma Navamī	पुष्पम् (flower), कोकिलः (cuckoo), आम्रः (mango tree)
ग्रीष्मः	Ratha Yātrā	तापः (heat), सूर्यः (sun), छाया (shade)
वर्षाः	Rakṣābandhana, Gaṇeśa Caturthī, Oṇam	मेघः (cloud), वृष्टिः (rain), मयूरः (peacock), मण्डूकः (frog)
शरत्	Navarātri, Vijayadaśamī, Dīpāvalī	चन्द्रः (moon), कमलम् (lotus), आकाशम् (sky)
हेमन्तः	Gītā Jayantī	हिमम् (frost, snow), धान्यम् (grain, harvest)
शिशिरः	Makara Saṅkrānti, Vasanta Pañcamī, Mahāśivarātri, Holi	शीतम् (cold), अग्निः (fire), वायुः (wind)

Holi falls on the full moon of Phālguna, at the end of Śiśira, welcoming Vasanta. Makara Saṅkrānti (about 14 January) begins the solar Śiśira.

Exercise · ऋतवः

1. श्रावणः and भाद्रपदः belong to _____ .
2. Dīpāvalī comes in _____ .
3. The season of cuckoos and mango blossoms is _____ .
4. शीतम् (cold) is a word for _____ .
5. Write the six seasons in order: _____

षड्रस प्राशनम् (Ṣaḍrasa Prāśanam), the six tastes

On Ugādi / Yugādi (the new year in Caitra) families taste one mixture that holds all six tastes.

षड्रसं जीवनं प्रोक्तं सुखदुःखसमन्वितम्।

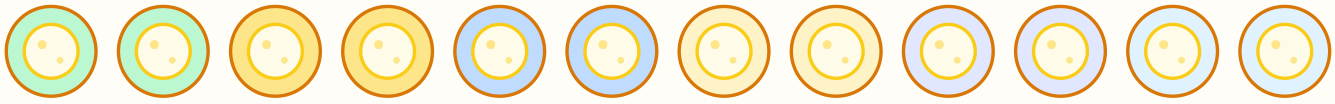
Life is said to have six tastes, joined with joy and sorrow.

निम्ब-गुड-मिश्रणम् (Nimba-Guḍa-Miśraṇam): neem-jaggery mixture · **षड्रस प्राशनम्**: ritual tasting of the six tastes

Taste	Sound	Ingredient	Life feeling
मधुर	madhura	jaggery	joy
तिक्त	tikta	neem flowers	sorrow
अम्ल	amla	tamarind	surprises
कटु	kaṭu	chilli / pepper	anger
लवण	lavaṇa	salt	fear of the unknown
कषाय	kaṣāya	raw mango	disappointment

A similar mango-neem pachadi is made for Tamil Puthandu and Meṣa Saṅkrānti.

The twelve months · मासाः



Each lunar month is named after the nakṣatra (star) near the full moon. Gregorian months are approximate. ★ = has its own section in this book.

Month	Sound	About	Ṛtu	Main festival
चैत्रः	caitraḥ	Mar – Apr	वसन्तः	Ugādi / Gudi Padwa, Rāma Navamī ★
वैशाखः	vaiśākhaḥ	Apr – May	वसन्तः	Akṣaya Tṛtīyā, Buddha Pūrṇimā
ज्येष्ठः	jyeṣṭhaḥ	May – Jun	ग्रीष्मः	Vaṭa Pūrṇimā
आषाढः	āṣāḍhaḥ	Jun – Jul	ग्रीष्मः	Ratha Yātrā, Guru Pūrṇimā
श्रावणः	śrāvaṇaḥ	Jul – Aug	वर्षाः	Rakṣābandhana ★
भाद्रपदः	bhādrapadaḥ	Aug – Sep	वर्षाः	Gaṇeśa Caturthī ★, Kṛṣṇa Janmāṣṭamī ★ (Śrāvaṇa in some calendars), Oṇam ★ nearby
आश्विनः	āśvinaḥ	Sep – Oct	शरत्	Navarātri ★, Vijayadaśamī ★
कार्तिकः	kārtikaḥ	Oct – Nov	शरत्	Dīpāvalī ★
मार्गशीर्षः	mārgaśīrṣaḥ	Nov – Dec	हेमन्तः	Gītā Jayantī
पौषः	pauṣaḥ	Dec – Jan	हेमन्तः	Makara Saṅkrānti ★ (about 14 Jan)
माघः	māghaḥ	Jan – Feb	शिशिरः	Vasanta Pañcamī
फाल्गुनः	phālgunaḥ	Feb – Mar	शिशिरः	Mahāśivarātri ★, Holi ★

Solar (rāśi) months · सौरमासाः

मेषः meṣaḥ	वृषभः vṛṣabhaḥ	मिथुनम् mithunam	कर्कटः karkaṭaḥ	सिंहः siṃhaḥ	कन्या kanyā
तुला tulā	वृश्चिकः vṛścikaḥ	धनुः dhanuḥ	मकरः makaraḥ	कुम्भः kumbhaḥ	मीनः mīnaḥ

A solar month begins when the sun enters a rāśi: मेषः from about mid-April, मकरः from about 14 January (Makara Saṅkrānti).

Exercise · मासाः

1. Dīpāvalī falls in _____ .
2. The month after चैत्रः is _____ .
3. Rakṣābandhana is in _____ , in the ṛtu _____ .
4. The sun enters _____ on Makara Saṅkrānti.

Mixed quiz · मिश्र-प्रश्नाः

A. Which festival does each word belong to?

1. मोदकः → _____
2. तिलगुडम् → _____
3. शमीवृक्षः → _____
4. रङ्गवल्ली → _____
5. पुष्परङ्गवल्ली (pookkalam) → _____
6. रक्षा → _____
7. होलिका → _____
8. पतङ्गः → _____
9. मूषकः → _____
10. दीपः → _____
11. नवरात्रिः → _____
12. महाबलिः → _____
13. वेणुः → _____
14. बिल्वपत्रम् → _____
15. अयोध्या → _____
16. रावणदहनम् → _____

B. Finish the line

17. वक्रतुण्ड महाकाय _____
18. तमसो मा _____
19. सर्वे भवन्तु _____

Festival greetings · उत्सव-शुभाशयाः

Sanskrit	Sound	Meaning
दीपावलीशुभाशयाः	dīpāvalīśubhāśayāḥ	Happy Dīpāvalī!
गणेशचतुर्थीशुभाशयाः	gaṇeśacaturthīśubhāśayāḥ	Happy Gaṇeśa Caturthī!
विजयदशमीशुभाशयाः	vijayadaśamīśubhāśayāḥ	Happy Vijayadaśamī!
ओणम्-शुभाशयाः	oṇam-śubhāśayāḥ	Happy Oṇam!
मकरसङ्क्रान्तिशुभाशयाः	makarasaṅkrāntiśubhāśayāḥ	Happy Makara Saṅkrānti!
होलिकोत्सवशुभाशयाः	holikotsavaśubhāśayāḥ	Happy Holi!
रक्षाबन्धनशुभाशयाः	rakṣābandhanaśubhāśayāḥ	Happy Rakṣābandhana!
कृष्णजन्माष्टमीशुभाशयाः	kṛṣṇajanmāṣṭamīśubhāśayāḥ	Happy Janmāṣṭamī!
रामनवमीशुभाशयाः	rāmanavamīśubhāśayāḥ	Happy Rāma Navamī!
महाशिवरात्रिशुभाशयाः	mahāśivarātriśubhāśayāḥ	Happy Mahāśivarātri!
तिलगुडं गृहाण, मधुरं वद।	tilaguḍaṃ gṛhāṇa, madhuraṃ vada	Take sesame-jaggery, speak sweetly.
भवते / भवत्यै शुभाशयाः।	bhavate / bhavatyai śubhāśayāḥ	Best wishes to you (to a man / a woman).

Make a greeting card

To / प्रति: _____

_____ शुभाशयाः!

From / इति: _____

Answer key · उत्तराणि (1)

Festival exercises (1-5 on each śloka page)

Dīpāvalī	1 lamp · 2 oil · 3 rangoli (coloured floor design) · 4 दीपावली · 5 अमावास्या
Gaṇeśa Caturthī	1 Gaṇeśa · 2 modaka (sweet dumpling) · 3 the big-bellied one · 4 गणपतिः · 5 विसर्जनम्
Navarātri	1 nine nights · 2 Sarasvatī · 3 fasting · 4 दुर्गा · 5 गरबा
Dasarā · Vijayadaśamī	1 the tenth day of victory · 2 Rāvaṇa · 3 worship of tools and weapons · 4 दशहरा · 5 विद्यारम्भः
Oṇam	1 Śravaṇa star (Thiruvonam day) · 2 flower carpet (Malayalam: pookkalam) · 3 boat race (Malayalam: vallam kali) · 4 महाबलिः · 5 केरलम्
Makara Saṅkrānti	1 sun entering Makara · 2 sesame · 3 kite · 4 सूर्यः · 5 धान्यम्
Holi	1 Holikā (the bonfire night) · 2 month of Phālguna · 3 water · 4 प्रह्लादः · 5 मित्रम्
Mahāśivarātri	1 Śiva · 2 bilva leaf · 3 small hand drum · 4 रात्रिः · 5 जागरणम्
Rakṣābandhana	1 tying of the protective thread · 2 brother · 3 month of Śrāvaṇa · 4 रक्षा · 5 उपहारः
Rāma Navamī	1 Rāma · 2 King Daśaratha · 3 Lakṣmaṇa · 4 नवमी · 5 रामायणम्
Kṛṣṇa Janmāṣṭamī	1 Kṛṣṇa · 2 flute · 3 fresh butter · 4 जन्माष्टमी · 5 मध्यरात्रिः

Answer key · उत्तराणि (2)

Mixed quiz A

1. Gaṇeśa Caturthī
2. Makara Saṅkrānti
3. Vijayadaśamī
4. Dīpāvalī
5. Oṇam
6. Rakṣābandhana
7. Holi
8. Makara Saṅkrānti
9. Gaṇeśa Caturthī
10. Dīpāvalī
11. Navarātri
12. Oṇam
13. Kṛṣṇa Janmāṣṭamī
14. Mahāśivarātri
15. Rāma Navamī
16. Vijayadaśamī

Adornment: label the picture

1 बिन्दुः · 2 कुण्डलम् · 3 हारः · 4 कङ्कणम् · 5 नूपुरम् · 6 मेखला · 7 नासाभरणम् · 8 कज्जलम् · 9 वेणी · 10 शाटी · 11 कञ्चुकः · 12 मेन्धिका

Write the word: तोरणम् · पुष्पमाला · नूपुरम्

Seasons exercise

1. वर्षाः (varṣāḥ)
2. शरत् (śarat)
3. वसन्तः (vasantaḥ)
4. शिशिरः (śiśiraḥ); हेमन्तः is also accepted
5. वसन्तः, ग्रीष्मः, वर्षाः, शरत्, हेमन्तः, शिशिरः

Months exercise

1. कार्तिकः (kārtikaḥ)
2. वैशाखः (vaiśākhaḥ)
3. श्रावणः · वर्षाः
4. मकरः (makaraḥ)

Mixed quiz B

17. सूर्यकोटिसमप्रभ
18. ज्योतिर्गमय
19. सुखिनः

> शोभनम्! Well done! · उत्सवाः आनन्ददायकाः। (Festivals bring joy.)